

My definitions of:



Game **mechanics**



Game **systems**



Game **loops**

Game mechanics

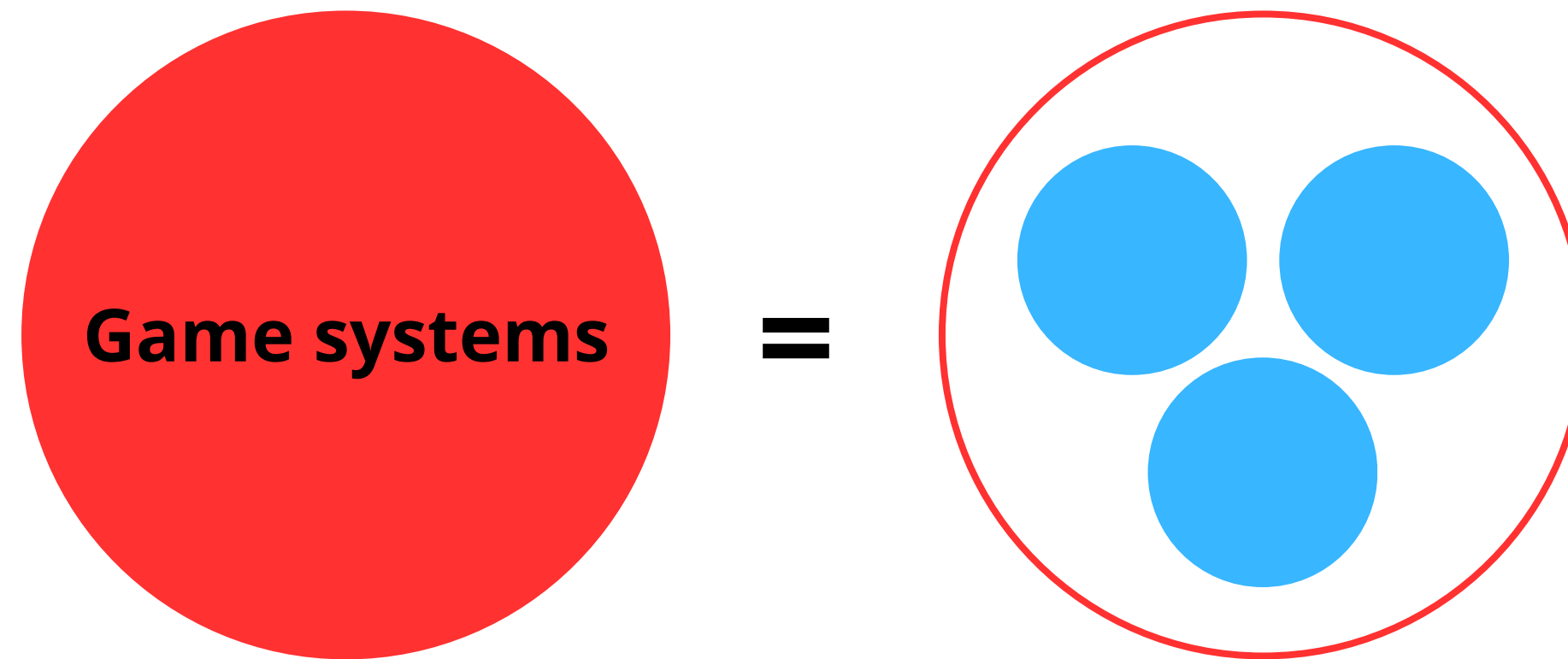
Game mechanics are the rules that define or guide what players can do.

The player can rightclick to auto attack



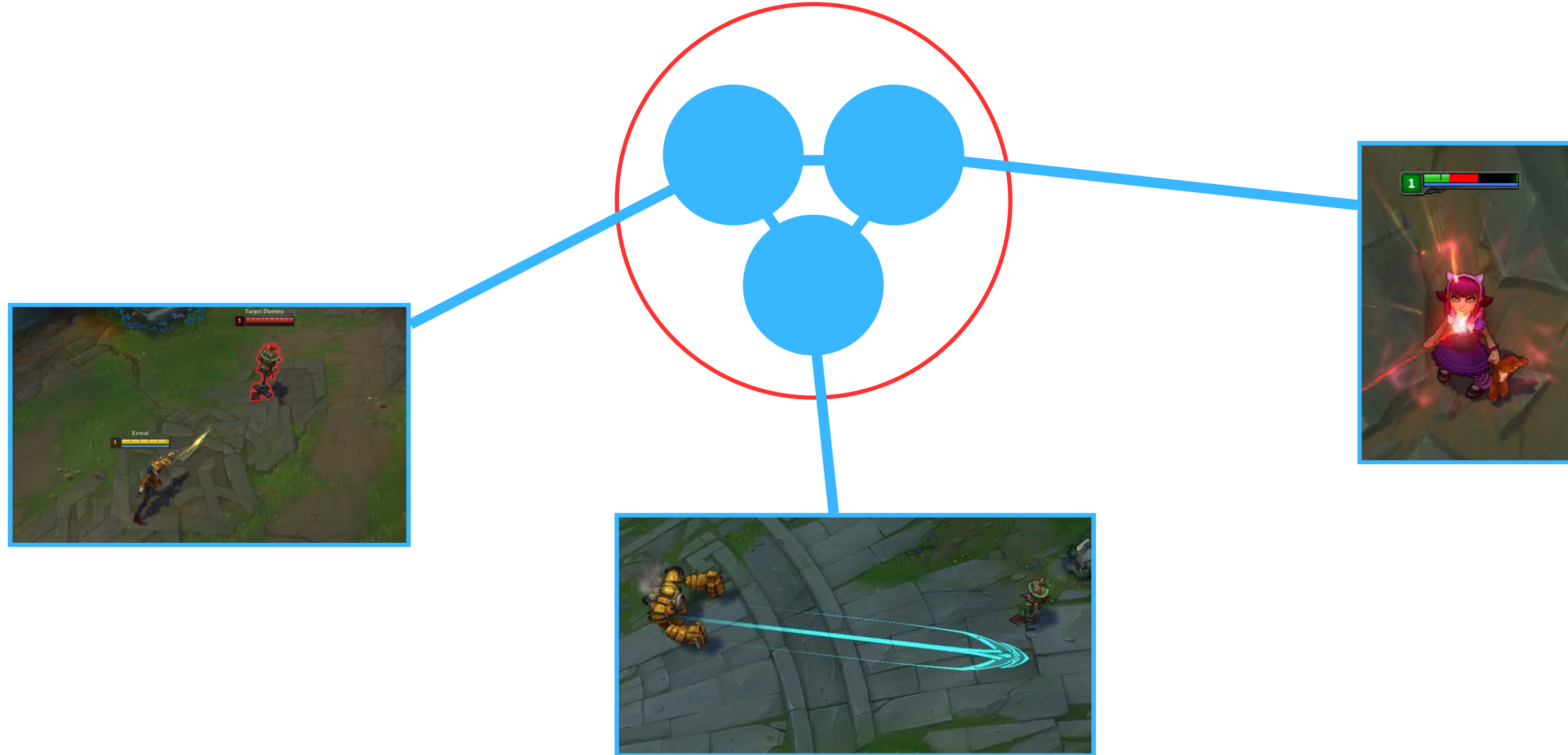
The player can press Q to cast a spell





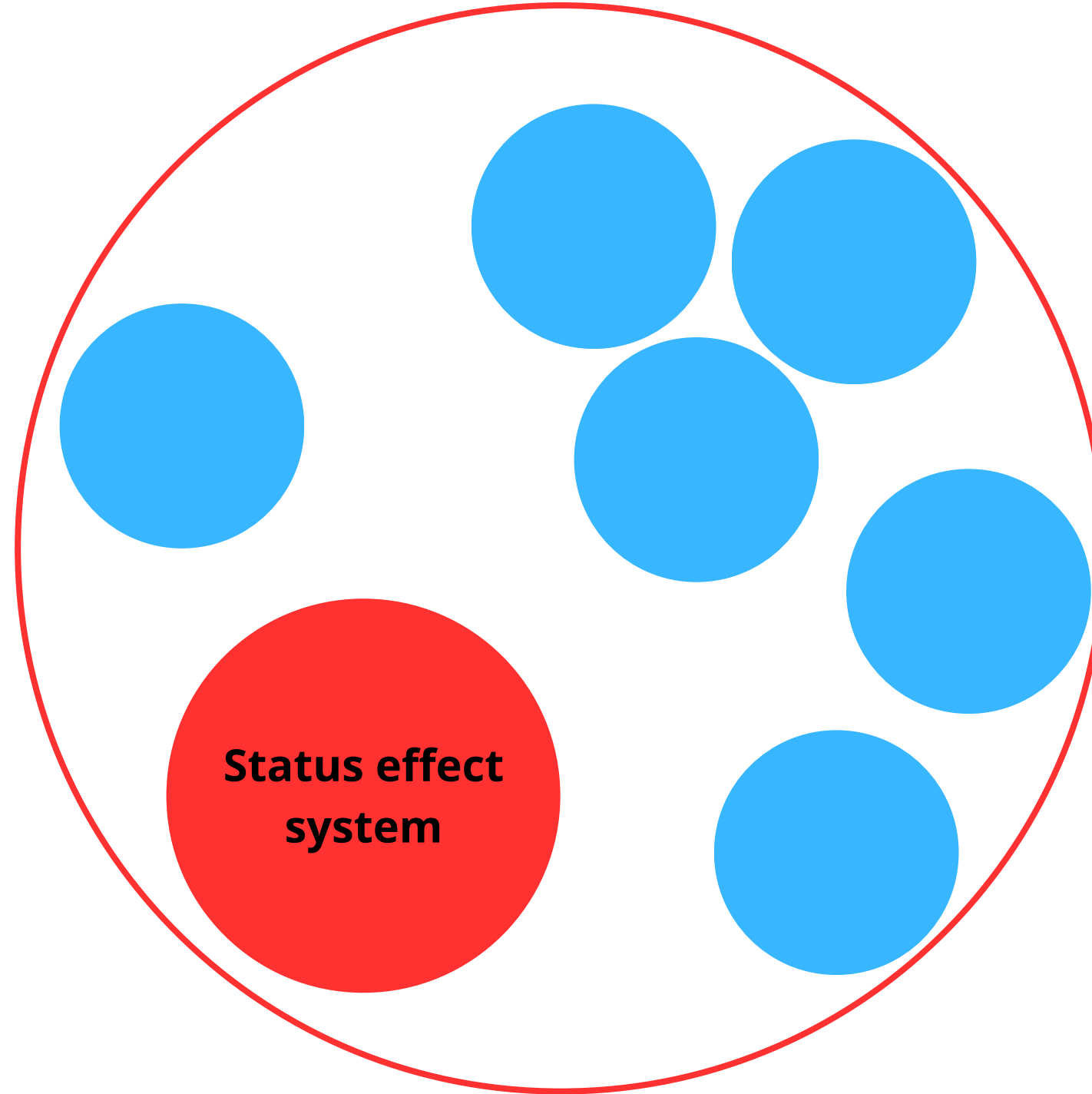
Game systems are a bunch of connected game mechanics in a frenchcoat

Combat system



They work together toward a specific function (this case, combat)

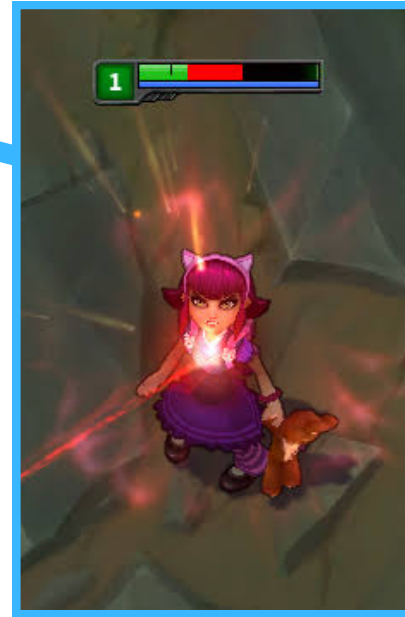
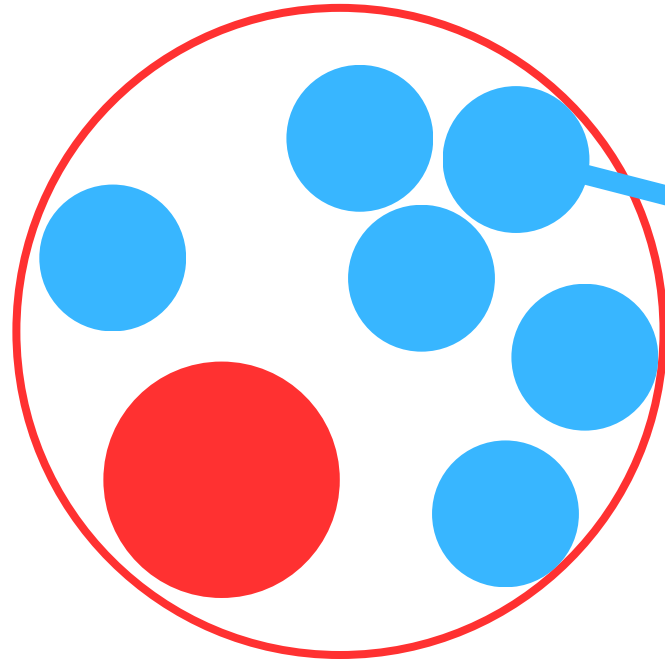
Combat system



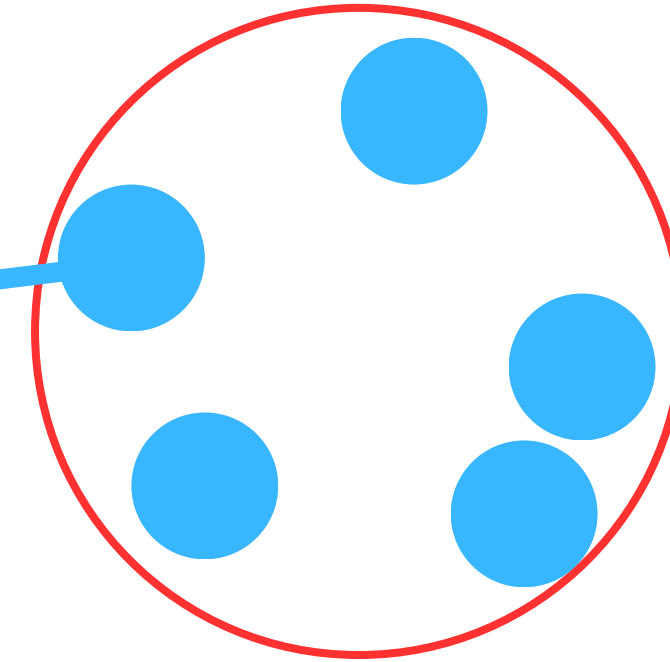
A game system can also be composed of other game system(s).

Something something ception

Combat system



Item system



Two game systems can share a game mechanic

Game loops

(designer)

Not to be confused with

Game loops

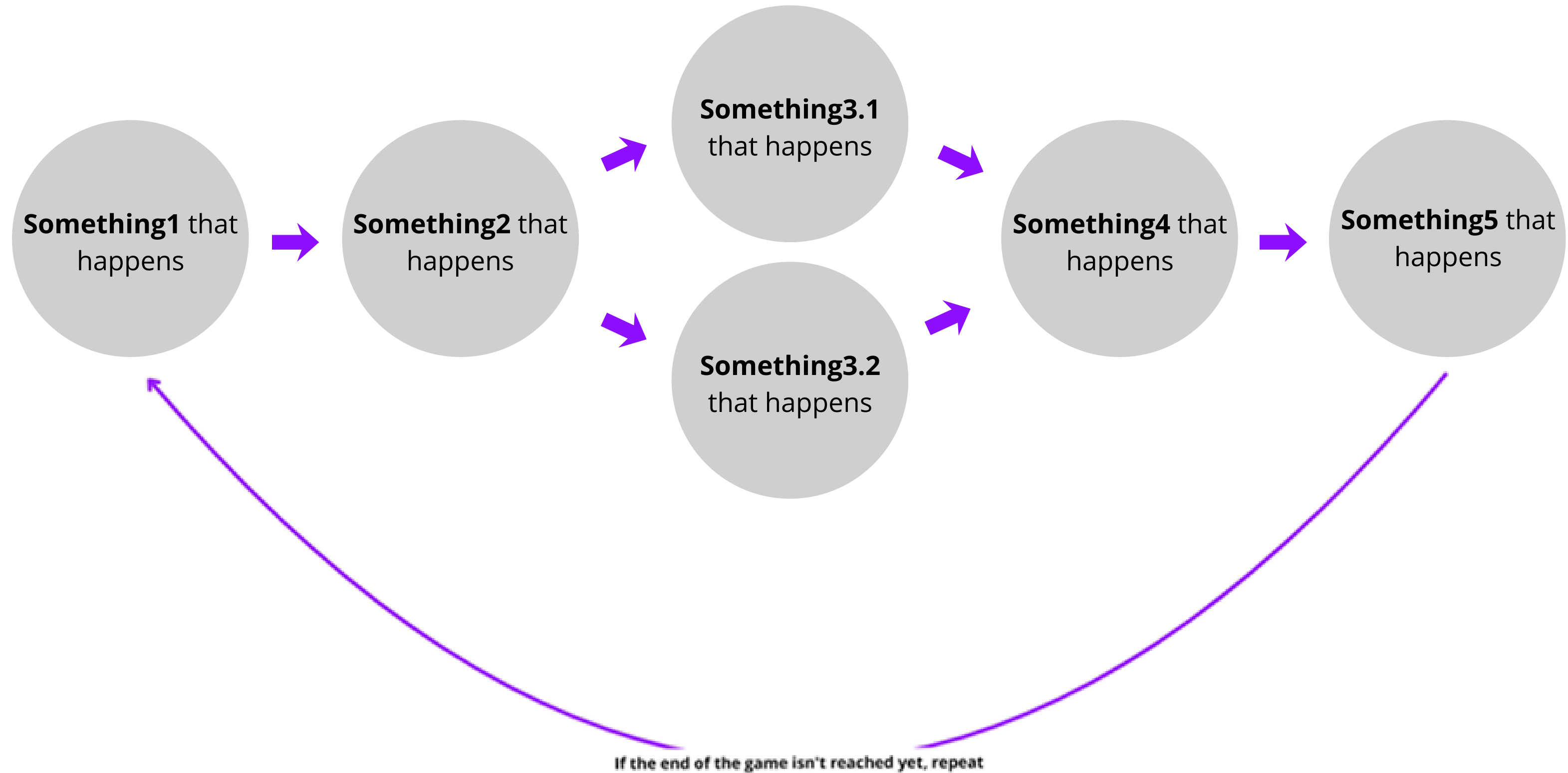
(developer)

- 1. process player input →
- 2. update game stuff **TECHNICAL** →
- 3. render game stuff **VISUAL** →

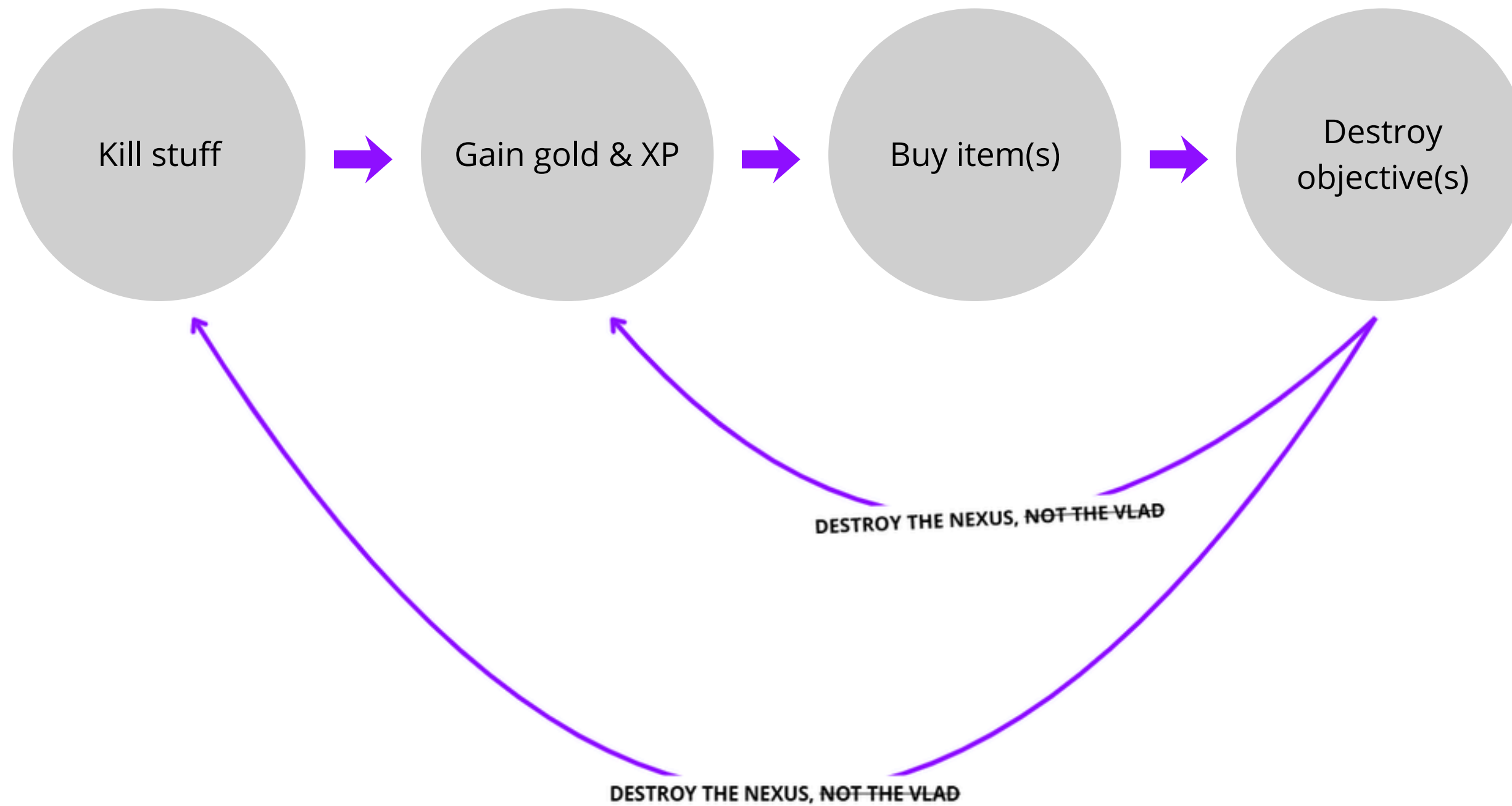
(The definition of game loops differ depending on if you ask a game designer or a game developer)

Game loop

A game loop has a bunch of repeating steps:

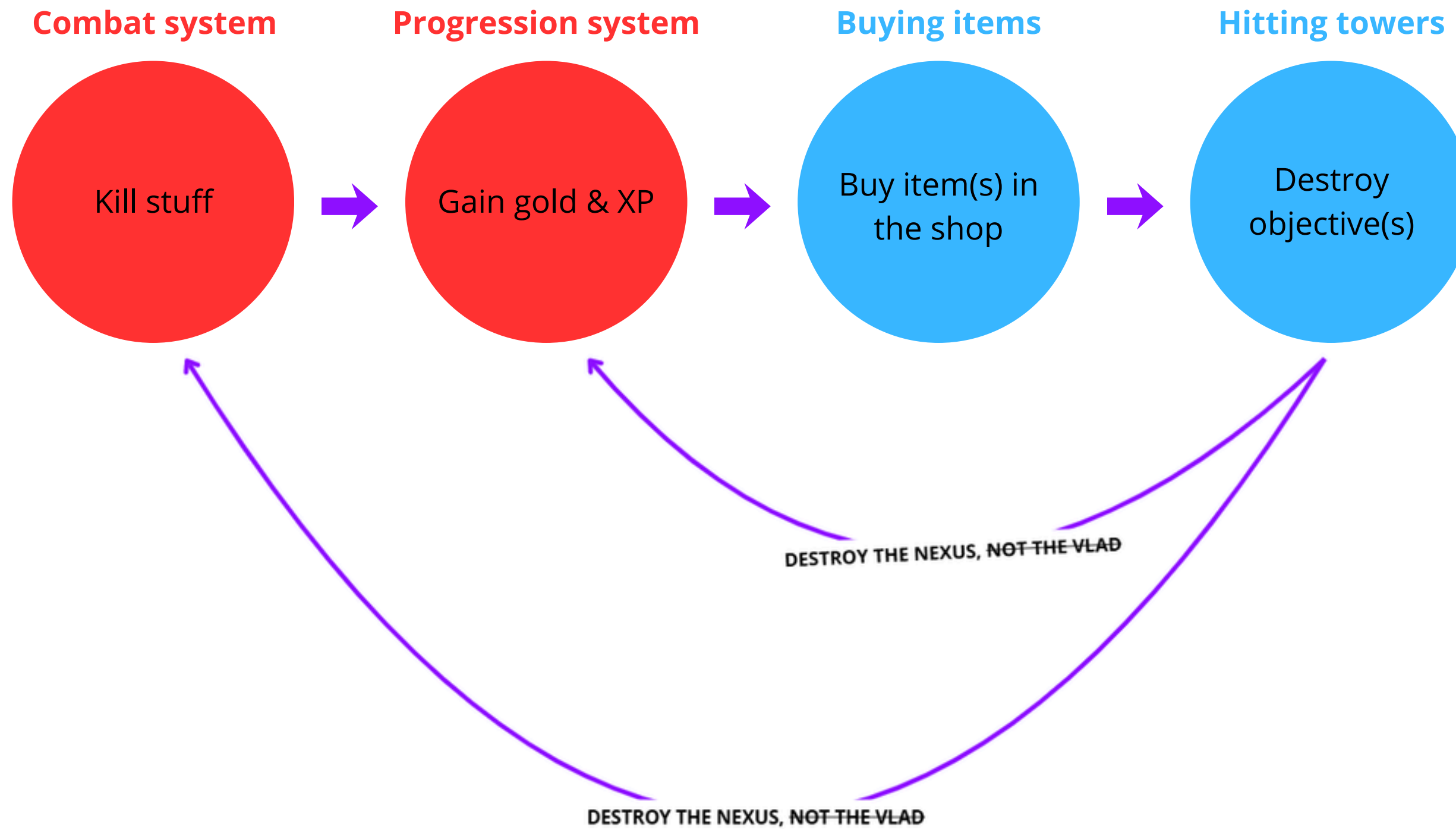


One of 's Game loops:

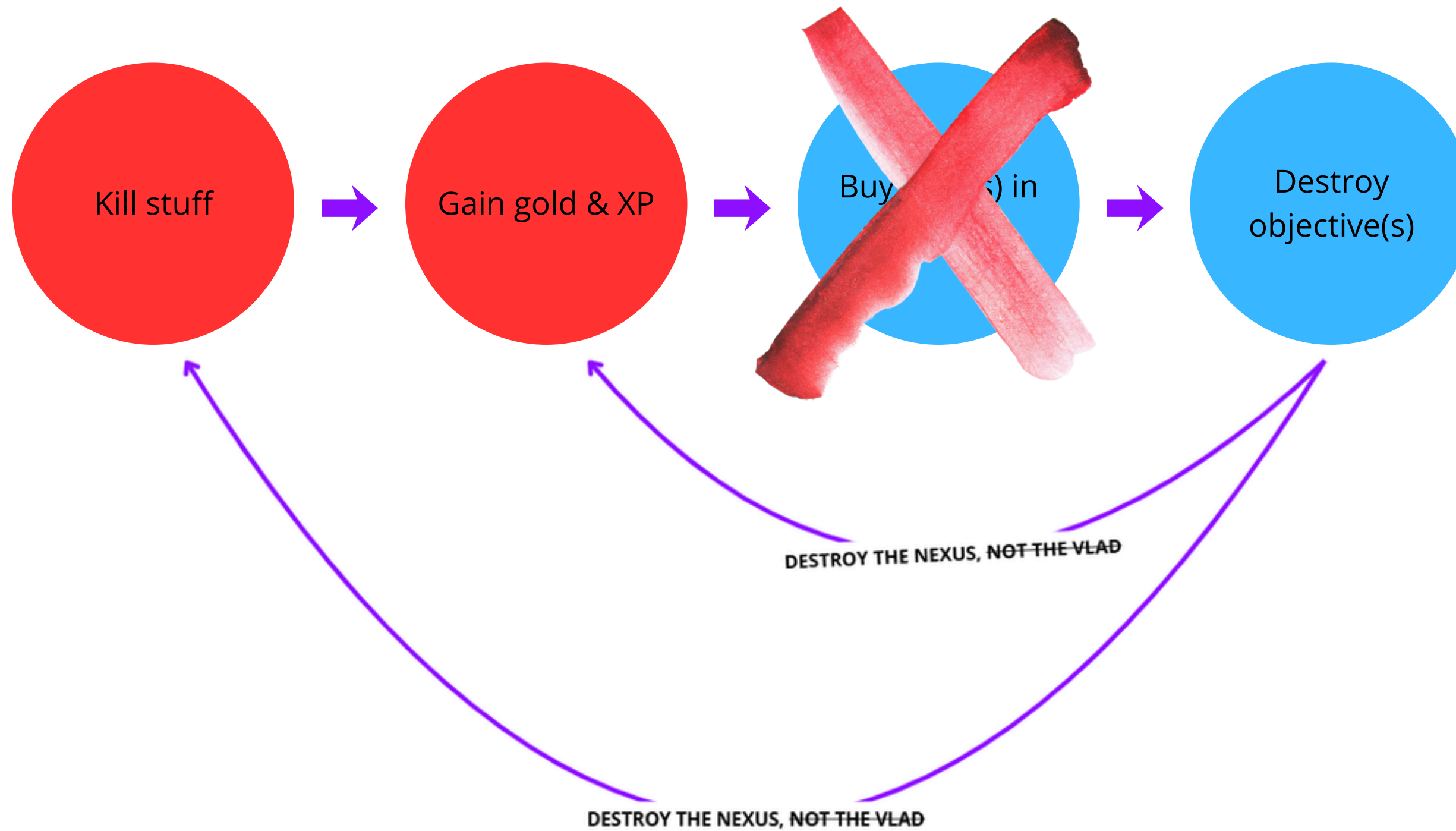


Pay attention, and you'll notice...

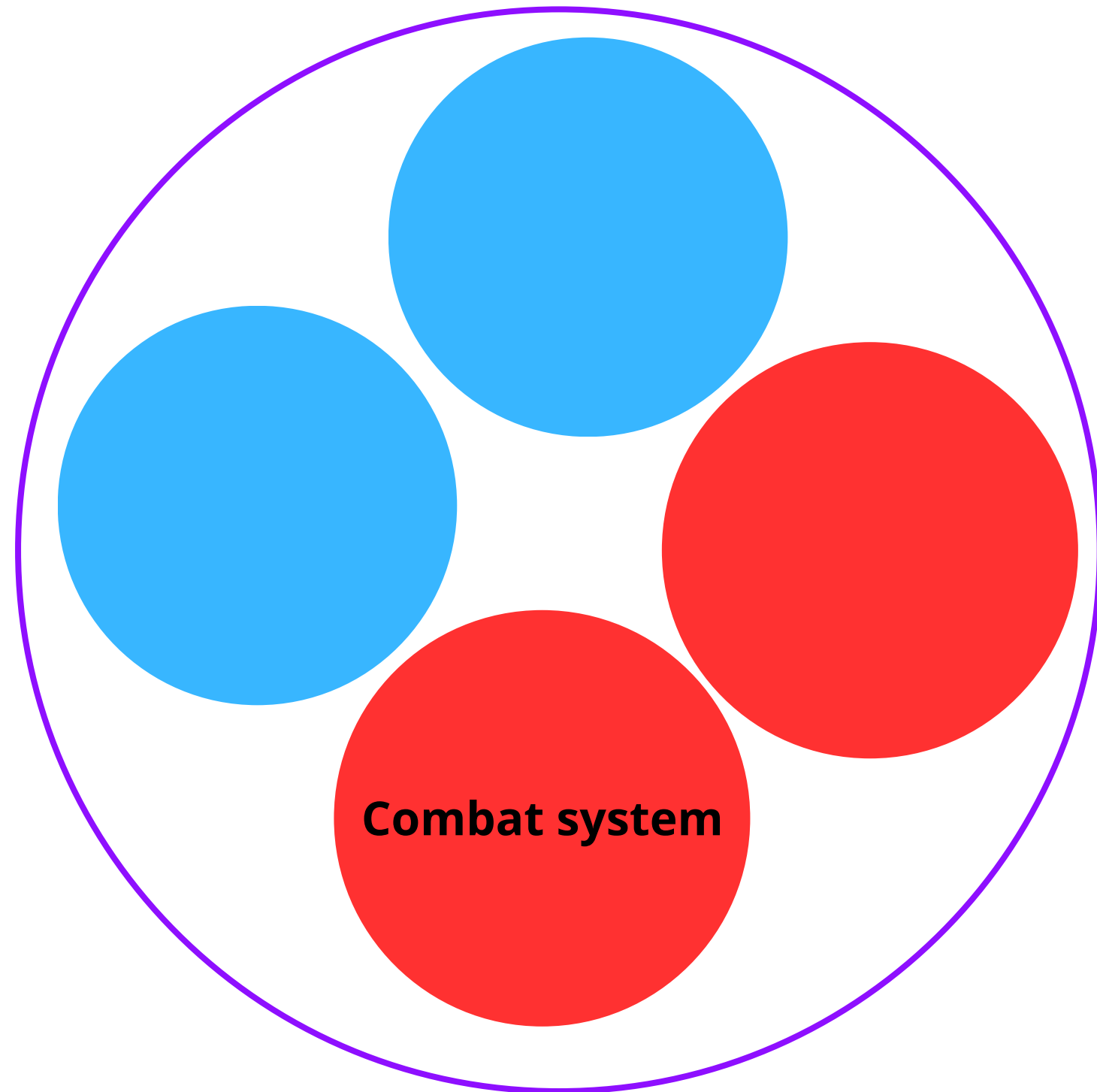
THESE ARE THE PREVIOUS BALLS WE TOUCHED ON!



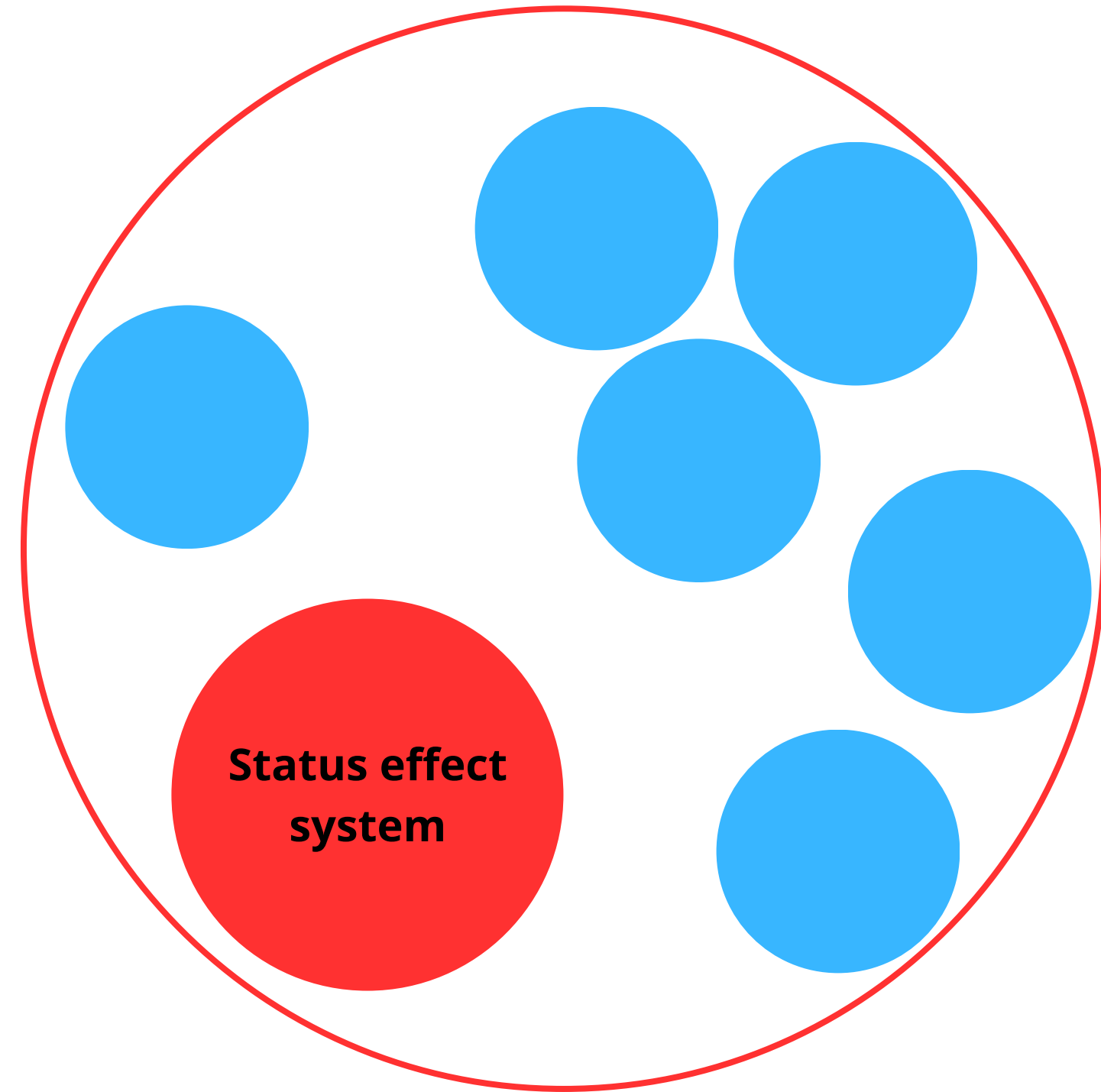
Yes it's possible for players to be quirky and skip a step, but then that wouldn't be the **INTENDED** game loop



Game **Loops**

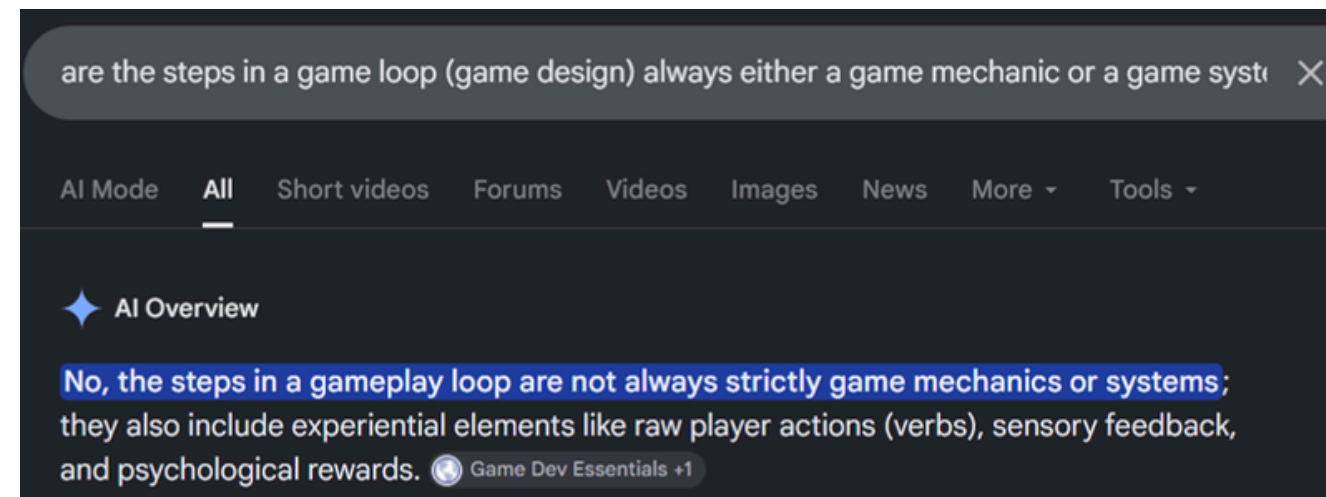


Combat system



It's like atoms and molecules and, idk

These are **my** definitions. Google's AI overview seems to disagree with me



But I don't care, because game design isn't a hard science

You just have to apply what works for you (and your team)

I deadass reached a flow state while making this